

Ask Cinderhaven — Which channel actually makes money?

baseline scenario — figures reconcile to Channel Profitability Analysis

Which channel actually makes money?

All channels are contribution-margin positive. Retailer leads with \$26,451,614 (68% of revenue). DTC is weakest at \$299,091 — positive but worth watching given its cost structure.

all channels positive

Key numbers

Retailer	Best channel \$26,451,614 contribution margin
DTC	Weakest channel \$299,091
\$37,556,760	Total contribution margin

How this verdict was reached

Source: mart_channel_contribution — the only table where retailer, distributor, and DTC pipelines are reconciled on a common cost basis. Contribution margin = net_revenue — COGS — trade_spend. Any negative contribution_margin is an automatic verdict.

Go deeper

Channel Profitability Analysis: <https://lailarallc.com/channel-profitability>

Data: Cinderhaven Provisions, a synthetic demonstration dataset (not a client).

Built by Lailara LLC — data hygiene and analytics consulting for specialty food brands scaling into national retail.
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